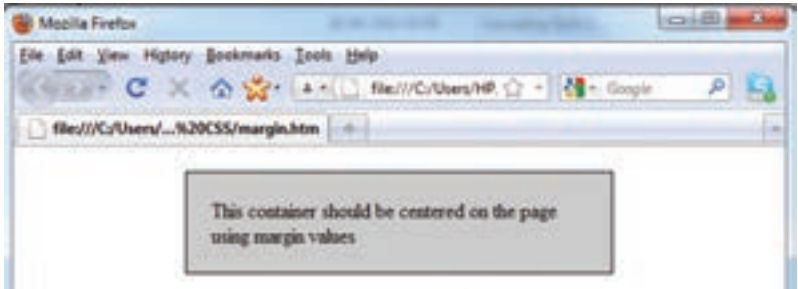


```
/* Basic container */
#container {
width:300px;
margin-top: 20px;
margin-left: auto;
margin-right: auto;
margin-bottom: 1em;
border: 1px solid #000;
padding: 20px;
background: #CCC;
}
```

The container is now 20 pixels from the top edge of the <body> element, and is centred due to its set width combined with left and right margins



The margin:auto values centre the container with respect to the browser window.

set to auto. A couple of easy shortcuts are available to reduce up to four margin:value declarations into one.

```
/* Basic container */
#container {
margin: 20px auto 1em auto;
}
```

The order of the values is very important here. The order is top (20px), right (auto), bottom (1em), and left (auto). The best way to center an element using CSS is to use the auto value for left and right margins. For modern browsers, all this requires is a set width rule and the left and right margins given the auto value.